



Figure 6: Security manager



Figure 7: Confirm macro enabling

which can be placed under the existing menu or an altogether new menu

- A tool bar item can be created
- A keyboard shortcut can be assigned

To achieve all this, follow the options under the different tabs of the *Customize* window—*Tools*→*Customize*.

Suppose a new menu item has to be created for the previous example of FindAndRed (for searching a key pattern and highlighting all cells in red), then the following steps are helpful to create a menu item.

Go to *Tools*→*Customize*→*Menus*. Under *Menu List* select an existing menu or create a new one by selecting the *New* option. In this example let's create a new menu called 'My Menu' (Figure 3).

Under *Menu Content*→*Entries*, use the *Add* option. Scroll to the end and specify the macro from the available list. A new menu titled 'My Menu' will appear. Under this a menu item with the macro name of 'Main' will appear for invoking the macro. You can use the *Rename* option under the *Modify* button to change the default name from 'Main' to 'FindNRed', or anything else for that matter.

A similar process can be followed to create a toolbar item. Let's see another example of assigning a key combination for the same macro.

Go to *Tools*→*Customize*→*Keyboard*. Under the list of functions select the 'OpenOffice.org Macros' category and choose the macro. From the list of available keys select one which is free (better not to disturb standard shortcuts) and use the *Modify* option to assign it.

As you can see in Figure 4, we have assigned *Shift+F3* to the FindAndRed macro.

Macros as event handlers

Want to perform some task on starting or closing an application, or opening or closing a document? It's easy in OOo—put the desired code in a macro and it can be associated with some event by accessing *Tools*→*Customize*→*Events* (Figure 5).

Macro security

Although macros have their own advantages, they are dangerous too! Macros may contain vulnerable code that may harm the files and even your system. That said, there's no need to worry too much about this. OOo provides different levels of security to handle macros in documents.

- **Very High:** Only from trusted sources, even signed macros from untrusted sources are disabled.
- **High:** Signed macros from trusted sources only.
- **Medium:** Confirms before enabling macros while opening a document if it's from an untrusted source.
- **Low:** All macros will be executed without any confirmation.

To control the security level, configure *Tools*→*Options*→*OpenOffice.org*→*Security*→*Macro Security*. Refer to Figures 6 and 7.

Trusted locations and certificates can be managed from the second tab of the *Security manager* window (Figure 6).

There are a few limitations with OOBasic macros. OOBasic is a scripting language, so the code for macros is always available with the document. Even though it's a good practice as per the open source philosophy, at the user level one may damage the code accidentally (or even intentionally), which may cause a huge loss of data or corrupt the system.

Extensions written in compiled languages are a better solution in this respect, as only the binary of the extension will be available to the end user. Only trusted persons with a knowledge of programming can be provided the source code. 

References

- OpenOffice.org website: www.openoffice.org
- VBA-enabled OOo: go-oo.org
- OOo wiki—very helpful for developers: wiki.services.openoffice.org
- OOo API: api.openoffice.org

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